



INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT RANCHI

MBA

2026-28

Core

COURSE NAME: The Entrepreneurial Manager
TERM: II
CREDITS: 3

FACULTY DETAILS:

Name	Faculty Office Address	Email	Section
Prof. Anurag Chaturvedi	709 (Seventh Floor), Sidhu-Kanhu Block	anurag.chaturvedi@iimranchi.ac.in	1 Section
Prof. Asimabha Bhowmick	609 (Sixth Floor), Sidhu-Kanhu Block	asimabha.bhowmick@iimranchi.ac.in	2 Sections
Prof. Arun Singh Rana	512 (Fifth Floor), Birsa-Munda Block	arun.singh@iimranchi.ac.in	1 Section
Prof. Sagnika Datta	505 (Fifth Floor), Birsa-Munda Block	sagnika.datta@iimranchi.ac.in	1 Section

CONSULTATION TIME FOR STUDENTS: By prior appointment

COURSE DESCRIPTION:

The entrepreneurial spirit is said to be one of the most significant developments in recent economic history. Heightened levels of entrepreneurial activity are being witnessed across the globe. Entrepreneurial behaviour (both at the individual and firm levels) is reshaping the business ecosystem, creating an environment where it plays a major role in introducing innovations, commercializing new technologies, creating new jobs, opening up new markets, and creating value by combining resources in exciting new ways. This course will be useful for those interested in starting or working for an entrepreneurial venture and those who desire to develop an intrapreneurial mindset while working for established firms.

Through a combination of lectures, readings, assignments, case discussions, and group projects, the course will examine the key features of entrepreneurship as well as matters of concern for prospective entrepreneurs. The sessions are conducted in an interactive manner, which would help students understand the theories and concepts through a critical analysis and discussion of the assigned readings and cases as well as their application to real-life situations. Hence, a high degree of pre-class preparation with the readings and cases is needed for effective class participation and learning by the students.

COURSE OBJECTIVE:

- Identify and analyse managerial and strategic issues related to building and managing startups.
- Apply concepts from design thinking to come up with a business idea, based on which create a business model and make a business plan.
- Analyse and use tools and techniques such as ‘business model canvas’ and ‘the lean startup’ related to the practice of entrepreneurship.
- Understand the entrepreneurial ecosystem and its importance.
- Understand the problems confronted by entrepreneurs and the dilemmas that emerge as the business grows.
- Promote entrepreneurial thinking among students and make them aware about the startup policies of the Government of India and the State of Jharkhand.

Textbook: No

Reference Books:

1. Entrepreneurship in Developing and Emerging Economies by Aji J. Ahmed, Punita Bhatt and Iain Acton, Sage Publication. ISBN: 978-93-532-8533-3 (PB), 2021
2. Kuratko, D.F., 2019. Entrepreneurship: Theory, Process, Practice. 11th ed. Boston, MA: Cengage Learning.

CLO – PLT – ASSESSMENT TOOL MAPPING:

CLOs	Course Learning Outcome (CLO)	Program Level Trait (PLT)	Assessment Tool(s)
CLO1	Develop an understanding of the concepts of innovation and entrepreneurship among students.	Students should be able to apply appropriate methodologies to solve different business problems	Group Assignment

CLO2	Build a business model based on a business idea and develop the ability to communicate the business model to people in the entrepreneurial world by making an elevator pitch and presenting a business plan.	Students should be able to identify the interconnectedness across business functions	Working with AI Mid-Term Project
CLO3	Develop an understanding of the challenges faced by entrepreneurs in growing their entrepreneurial ventures.	Students should be able to identify the interconnectedness across business functions	End Term Exam
CLO4	Assess students' skills in terms of risk-taking, and help them reflect on their new venture ideas, and the opportunities for combining skills and experiences obtained as a working professional and that as an innovator/entrepreneur.	Students should be able to prescribe recommendations to complex business problems	End Term Project Group Assignment

EVALUATION SCHEME:

Evaluation Components as per Program Manual Rules	Details	Weightage (%)
Working with AI assignment	Individual assignment	25%
End Term Exam		40%
Attendance		10%
Midterm Group Project**	The students need to prepare an Elevator	10%

	Pitch for a potential business idea they generated	
End-term Group Project***	The students need to work on a Business Plan for a startup they propose to found based on the business idea they generated pre-midterm	15%
Total		100%

INDIVIDUAL ASSIGNMENT DETAILS (Working with AI):

Students may use generative AI tools (e.g., ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude) to support opportunity identification, market research, idea refinement, and business model development. All AI use must be disclosed in the submission, and students are responsible for ensuring the originality, accuracy, and quality of their work adhering to the guidelines by APO.

GROUP ASSIGNMENT DETAILS:

*Group tasks assigned prior to a session or as in-class assignment are to be carried out by the groups and a report is to be submitted before the deadline.

MID-TERM GROUP PROJECT DETAILS:

Student groups will develop and present an entrepreneurial solution to a real-world opportunity or challenge, applying the concepts covered during the first half of the course. The project will be evaluated on the quality of analysis, feasibility, innovation, teamwork, and the effectiveness of the presentation.

END-TERM GROUP PROJECT DETAILS:

Student groups will prepare and pitch a comprehensive venture proposal or business model that integrates the key concepts learned throughout the course. Assessment will be based on the quality of the opportunity identified, the strength of the value proposition and business model, strategic thinking, feasibility and implementation strategy, presentation quality, and the ability to defend assumptions and respond effectively to questions.

SOFTWARE(S) USED (Yes/No) (If yes, please provide details): **No**

FIELD TRIPS / WORKSHOPS PLANNED (Yes/No) (If yes, please provide details): **No**

ACADEMIC MISCONDUCT: Please refer to the latest MBA Program Manual provided to you.

ELEMENTS OF SOCIAL IMPACT IN COURSE CURRICULUM (YES/NO) (If yes, please mention session details/case details/other reading material details that have implications for social impact): **Yes (Refer to the Session on Social Entrepreneurship)**

DETAILED SESSION PLAN:

Session No.	Business Question	Topic(s) & Discussion Question	Readings	Pre-read/Case
1-2	What makes entrepreneurs entrepreneurial?	Effectuation: <i>How is effectual reasoning different from causal reasoning?</i> <i>What is effectuation process?</i> <i>What are effectuation principles?</i>	Article: The Entrepreneurial Method: How Expert Entrepreneurs Create New Markets, by Saras Sarasvathy, and Nick Dew Product #: UV0890-PDF-ENG The Bird-in-Hand Principle: Who I am, What I Know, and Whom I Know, by Saras Sarasvathy Product #: UV0843-PDF-ENG The Affordable Loss Principle, by Saras Sarasvathy Product #: UV1179-PDF-ENG	Cases: Cold Opportunity (A): The Nils Bergqvist Story Product #: UV2032-PDF-ENG Cold Opportunity (B): The ICEHOTEL Story Product #: UV2034-PDF-ENG Cold Opportunity (C): The Absolut ICEBARS Story Product #: UV2035-PDF-ENG

3	How to offer the right value to your customers?	Crafting a Value Proposition: <i>How would you strengthen or reposition the value proposition to better align with unmet customer needs?</i>	Industry and Background Note: FIELD Global Capstone: Developing Customer Empathy Product #: 316082-PDF-ENG	Case: Intuit's CEO on Building a Design-Driven Company Product #: R1501A-PDF-ENG
4	How to offer the right value to your customers?	Jobs to be done: <i>How to use the Jobs-to-be-Done framework and the Value Proposition Canvas to design products/services that offer the right value?</i>	Article: Know Your Customers' "Jobs to Be Done", by Clayton M. Christensen, Taddy Hall, Karen Dillon, David S Duncan, and David Duncan Product #: R1609D-PDF-ENG	Case: Saregama India Ltd.: Repositioning the Value Proposition Product #: W19618-PDF-ENG
5	How entrepreneurs mitigate risk, reduce costs, and accelerate time to market when launching new ventures?	Experimentation (Lean Startup): <i>How will you experiment with startup ideas?</i>	Article: Why the Lean Start-Up Changes Everything, by Steve Blank and Steven G. Blank Product #: R1305C-PDF-ENG	Simulation: New Venture Simulation: The Food Truck Challenge By: Michael A. Roberto Product #: 7201-HTM-ENG
6	How entrepreneurs mitigate risk, reduce costs, and accelerate time to market when launching new ventures?	The Lean Startup Methodology: <i>How is the lean startup methodology useful for launching new ventures quickly and effectively?</i>	Article: Why the Lean Start-Up Changes Everything, by Steve Blank and Steven G. Blank Product #: R1305C-PDF-ENG	Article: Hypothesis-Driven Entrepreneurship: The Lean Startup, by Thomas R. Eisenmann; Eric Ries; Sarah Dillard. Product #: 812095-PDF-ENG
7	How to organise around the value proposition to deliver and capture value from the new venture?	Business Model: <i>How will you design the building blocks of a startup using the Business Model Canvas?</i>	Article: Why business models matter, by Joan Magretta (HBR). Product #: 9985-PDF-ENG	Case: Zipcar: Refining the Business Model Product #: 803096-PDF-ENG
8	How to prepare and present a business plan for your startup?	Building and Presenting a Business Plan: <i>What are the critical components of a business plan?</i>	Article: How to Write a Winning Business Plan, by Stanley R. Rich, and David E. Gumpert (HBR).	Case: The Fish Whisperer (Ivey). Product #: W19039-PDF-ENG

		<i>How to write a great business plan?</i>	Product #: 85314-PDF-ENG	
9	How should entrepreneurs decide when and where to locate their startup enterprises?	The Entrepreneurial Ecosystem: <i>What are the key components of an entrepreneurial ecosystem and their characteristics?</i> <i>How do Hyderabad and Bengaluru differ from each other in terms of attracting the IT industry startups?</i>	Article: Entrepreneurial Ecosystems, by Stam, E. & Spigel, B. (2017). In R. Blackburn, D.D. Clercq & J. Heinonen (Eds.) The Sage Handbook of Small Business and Entrepreneurship. London: Sage	Article: Comparing the Entrepreneurial Ecosystems for Technology Startups in Bangalore and Hyderabad, India, by Bala Subrahmanya, M.H. (2017). Technology Innovation Management Review, 7(7), 47-62
10	What are the different sources of capital and the likely challenges in raising capital for startups?	Venture Funding and the Startup Challenge - the Sources of Capital: <i>What are the different stages of raising capital for a startup?</i> <i>What trade-offs between different sources of capital would you consider in terms of control, speed, risk, and long-term growth?</i>	Industry and Background Note: New Venture Financing, by Howard H. Stevenson & Michael J. Roberts (HBS). Product #: 802131-PDF-ENG	Case: Palm Computing, Inc.-1995: Financing Challenges (HBSP). Product #: 898090-PDF-ENG
11	What are the different challenges that the entrepreneurs face while scaling up their ventures for growth?	Scaling Up a Venture: <i>What are the various stages of customer journey for a startup?</i> <i>What challenges appeared with the explosive growth of customers of CloudFlare? Is this natural?</i>		Case: CloudFlare, Inc.: Running Hot (HBS). Product #: 813145-PDF-ENG
12	What are the issues confronted by entrepreneurs while they try to pass on the responsibility of the venture to the next generation – family or non-family members?	Succession Planning and Harvesting: <i>What are the various alternatives before Spyder's founder as he considers various exit options while ensuring sufficient liquidity to him and to his family members? Evaluate them.</i>	Article: The Key to Successful Succession Planning for Family Businesses, by Will Tabor & James Vardaman (HBS). Product #: H05MNN-PDF-ENG	Case: Spyder Active Sports—2004 (HBS). Product #: 206027-PDF-ENG

13	What are the issues and challenges faced in growing a family business?	Managing Family Business: <i>How is a family business different from an entrepreneurial venture?</i> <i>How has the Dhamani family successfully organized their family business and how is Dhamani planning to make its future move for further expansion?</i>	Article: The five attributes of enduring family businesses, by Christian Caspar, Ana Karina Dias, and Heinz-Peter Elstrodt (2010). McKinsey Quarterly, January 1, 2010.	Case: Dhamani Jewels: Becoming a Global Luxury Brand (HBS). Product #: 815087-PDF-ENG
14	What are the challenges that established companies face when they pursue new businesses and the usual problematic responses to those challenges?	Corporate Entrepreneurship: <i>How can large organizations overcome the barriers to innovation without losing momentum or getting shut down by corporate processes?</i>	Article: Meeting the Challenge of Corporate Entrepreneurship, by David A. Garvin & Lynne C. Levesque. Product #: R0610G-PDF-ENG	Case: Intrapreneurship at Alcatel-Lucent (Ivey). Product #: W14642-PDF-ENG
15	How to build ventures that will generate value for a large number of deprived people and cater to the UN mission based on of SDGs?	Social Entrepreneurship: <i>Can a social enterprise pursue both financial sustainability and deep social impact without compromising either?</i>	Article: Social Entrepreneurship: The Case for Definition by Roger L. Martin & Sally Osberg, <i>Stanford Social Innovation Review</i> , Spring 2007	Article: Seelos, C. & Mair, J. (2005). Social Entrepreneurship: Creating New Business Models to Serve the Poor. <i>Business Horizons</i> , 48(3), 241-246.
16	How can design thinking be used for generating customer-focused ideas for new products and services?	Design Thinking: <i>What is design thinking and its utility for entrepreneurs?</i> <i>What are the tools used for design thinking?</i>	Article: Energizing Innovation Through Design Thinking, by Cindy Tripp (Rotman). Product #: ROT210-PDF-ENG	Industry and Background Note: Ten Tools for Design Thinking, by Jeanne M. Liedtka & Timothy Ogilvie (UV). Product #: UV5187-PDF-ENG
17	How can an entrepreneur live with the uncertainty associated with entrepreneurship?	Managing Uncertainty in Entrepreneurship: <i>What are the risks and uncertainties associated with the growth options of Rough Water Brewing company?</i>	Article: Disciplined Entrepreneurship, by Donald N. Sull. (MIT Sloan). Product #: SMR156-PDF-ENG	Case: Rough Waters Brewing Company: Evaluating Decisions in Uncertain Environments (Ivey). Product #: W27802-PDF-ENG

18	How can an entrepreneur create a personal entrepreneurial roadmap?	Learning from a Serial Entrepreneur: <i>How could Elon Musk step around so many entrepreneurial activities and take crazy risks?</i>	Video: Entrepreneurship: Elon Musk The mind behind Tesla, SpaceX, SolarCity... (sub sp) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xM0388YlGrc	Case: Elon Musk's Big Bets (HBSP). Product #: 717431-PDF-ENG
19	How do government policies and regulations influence entrepreneurship?	Expert Session 1: <i>Government Perspective on Entrepreneurship /Startup Policy</i>	To be provided by the guest faculty	
20	What are the different challenges that entrepreneurs face while managing their ventures through startup, scaleup, and succession phases?	Expert Session 2: <i>Managing Your Own Business: Lessons from the field</i>	To be provided by the guest faculty	